

1. Sweating under his heavy load, Brian staggered up the stairs to his apartment. He felt as though his legs were crumbling beneath him.
(Add the fragment to the sentence that comes after it.)

Sweating ... load, Brian staggered ... apartment. He ...

2. He works 10 hours a day. ^{he} ~~Then~~ ^{he} goes to class for 2½ hours. It is no wonder he writes fragments.
(Connect the fragment by adding the subject *he* and changing *going* to the proper form of the verb, *goes*.)

1) He works ... and then he goes to class ... fragments.

2) He works ... then he goes to ...

3. Charlotte loved the movie *Gone with the Wind*, but Clyde hated it. His chief objection being that it lasted four hours.
(Correct the fragment by changing *being* to the proper verb form, *was*.)

Charlotte ... hated it. His chief objection was that it lasted four hours.

3) He works ... a day; then, he goes to ... fragments.

Activity 2

Underline the *-ing* or *to* fragment or fragments in each item. Then rewrite each item, using one of the methods of correction described on pages 374-375.

1. A mysterious package arrived on my porch yesterday, Bearing no return address. I half expected to find a bomb inside.

1) A mysterious ... yesterday, bearing ... address. I half ... inside.

2) Bearing no ... address, a mysterious ... yesterday. I half ... inside.

3) A mysterious ... yesterday. It was bearing ... address. I half ... inside.

2. Jack bundled up and went outside on the bitterly cold day. To saw wood for his fireplace. He returned half frozen with only two logs.

1) Jack ... day to saw ... fireplace. He returned ... logs.

2) To saw wood ... fireplace, Jack ... day. He returned ... logs.

3. Looking tired and drawn, the little girl's parents sat in the waiting room. The operation would be over in a few minutes.

1) Looking tired and drawn, the little ... room. The operation ... minutes.

2) The little ... room, looking ... drawn. The operation ... few minutes.

4. Sighing with resignation, Jill switched on her television set. She knew that the picture would be snowy and crackling with static. Her house being in a weak reception area.

1) Sighing... resignation, Jill ... set. She knew... static. Her house was in a... area.

2) Jill switched ... set, sighing ... resignation. She knew... static, Her

house was in a... area. 5. Jabbing the ice with a screwdriver, Luis attempted to speed up the defrosting process in his freezer. However, he used too much force. The result being a freezer compartment riddled with holes.

1) Jabbing ... screwdriver, Luis attempted ... freezer. However, he used... force, the result being ... holes.

2) Jabbing the ... screwdriver, Luis ... freezer. However, he ... force. The result was a freezer ... holes.

Added-Detail Fragments

Added-detail fragments lack a subject and a verb. They often begin with one of the following words:

also

especially

except

for example

including

such as

See if you can locate and underline the one added-detail fragment in each of the examples that follow:

Example 1

I love to cook and eat Italian food. Especially spaghetti and lasagna. I make everything from scratch.

Example 2

The class often starts late. For example, yesterday at a quarter after nine instead of at nine sharp. Today the class started at five after nine.

Example 3

He failed a number of courses before he earned his degree. Among them, English I, Economics, and General Biology.